Coupling the Point Model to the Growth Field

Key points of the meeting of 20 October 2026

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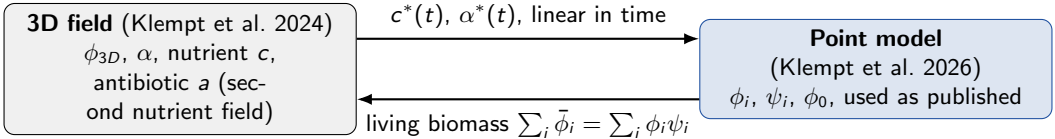
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What changes

- Point model (Klempt et al. 2026) used as published
- No scaling to the field ($\phi_0 = 1 - \phi_{3D}$ dropped)
- Field $\rightarrow$ point model: c^*, α^* from 3D fields
- Point model $\rightarrow$ field: only living biomass consumes
- Eq. 34 with front term, Eq. 36 unchanged

The loop at one Gauss point



$\sum_i \bar{\phi}_i$ scales the consumption of c and a $\rightarrow$ c enters the front term of Eq. 34 $\rightarrow$ spreading of ϕ_{3D} $\rightarrow$ growth α (Eq. 36) $\rightarrow$ stress

Equations

$$
\begin{aligned}
c^*(t) &= c_0^* \left[\tfrac{t_{n+1}-t}{\Delta t} c_n + \tfrac{t-t_n}{\Delta t} c_{n+1} \right], \quad \alpha^* \text{ likewise} \\
0 &= d\,\nabla^2 c - g\,\phi_{3D} \textstyle\sum_i \bar{\phi}_i\, c, \qquad \bar{\phi}_i = \phi_i \psi_i \\
0 &= d_a \nabla^2 a - g_a\,\phi_{3D} \textstyle\sum_i \bar{\phi}_i\, a \\
\dot{\phi} &= \beta \nabla^2 \phi + k_\alpha \alpha - \|\nabla \phi\| \tfrac{r\,c}{k+c}\, \mathbf{n}_{\nabla\phi} \cdot \mathbf{n}_{\nabla c}, \qquad \dot{\alpha} = k_\alpha \phi
\end{aligned}
$$

$g\phi$ in Eq. 35 of the paper is a misprint; $g\phi c$ is used.

Time: one clock for both models

- $T^* = 1$ = duration of the point model's data
- s follows from it, not fitted (synthetic: $s = 0.1$)
- Check (synthetic): error 7×10^{-7}; with scaling 0.019

Examples and checks

Examples (synthetic, two species)

- A centre, B edges
- A and B mixed
- with / without antibiotic

Checks

- equals point model alone
- ANSYS = Python
- $0 \leq \phi \leq 1$
- ϕ_{min}, step, mesh

Results to follow

Assumptions and open points

- Assumptions: linear interpolation, $\sum_i \bar{\phi}_i$ one step late, start values of new points, ϕ_{min}
- No transport of species between points
- Front term needs upwinding
- Antibiotic: synthetic data only ($b = 0$ in the calibration)

Appendix: notation

ϕ_{3D}, α	biofilm phase field and growth ($\mathbf{F}_g = \alpha\mathbf{I}$, $\alpha(0) = 1$), Klempt et al. 2024
c, a	nutrient and antibiotic fields (the element's first and second nutrient)
d, g, d_a, g_a	diffusion and consumption of nutrient and antibiotic
β, k_α, r, k	diffusion of ϕ, growth rate, front growth and Monod constant (Eq. 34, 36)
ϕ_i, ψ_i, ϕ_0	volume fraction and living fraction of species i, auxiliary void (Klempt et al. 2026)
c^*, α^*, b_i	nutrient and antibiotic of the point model, antibiotic sensitivity
$\bar{\phi}_i$	living volume fraction of species i, $\phi_i\psi_i$ (Klempt et al. 2026)
T^*, s	normalised time; point-model time per unit T^*